

Conference Travel

1. Purpose and Expectations

Conference participation is a vital component of academic training and professional development. It offers students the opportunity to present their research, receive scholarly feedback, build professional networks, and engage with the broader scientific community. Students are encouraged to participate in **at least one academic conference per year** to present their original research. To ensure productive and responsible participation, the following expectations apply:

- **Presentation Preparation:** All presentations must be rehearsed during a group meeting prior to the conference to receive feedback and strengthen delivery.
- **Travel Planning:** Travel arrangements must be made in advance and should prioritize the most efficient and cost-effective transportation and accommodation options.
- **Post-Conference Debrief:** Students are expected to share a brief reflection or summary with the group following the conference, highlighting key insights or outcomes.

2. Funding Sources

Students are responsible for monitoring deadlines and submitting timely applications to the following sources of conference funding:

1. **School of Graduate Studies (SGS) – Conference and Exposition Allowance**
For MASc, PhD, and Postdoc. Apply at least 30 days before the conference start date.
<https://www.concordia.ca/gradstudies/funding/in-program/conference-exposition-allowance.html>
2. **Graduate Students' Association (GSA) – Conference Funding**
For GSA members. Apply within 30 days after the conference (reimbursement-based).
<https://gsa.concordia.ca/services/gsa-funding/>
3. **Gina Cody School (GCS) – Conference Travel Support**
For 2nd or 3rd year PhD (exceptions may apply, check). Apply prior to the conference.
<https://www.concordia.ca/ginacody/about/funding-resources/budget-office.html>

After all available funding sources have been pursued, any remaining eligible travel costs may be covered by the PI's research grants, subject to availability of funds and prior approval.

3. Eligibility

Aligns with the criteria set by the **SGS Conference and Exposition Allowance**, i.e.,

- Must have an accepted presentation (oral or poster) at the conference.
- **MASc:** eligible once during their program, within the first two years.
- **PhD:** eligible up to three times, within the first five years.
- **Postdoc:** eligible up to twice, no more than once per academic year.

4. Notice of Intention

Students who plan to attend a conference must notify and discuss their intention with the PI at least **three months** prior to the conference's submission deadline.

5. Related Conferences

Students are encouraged to target reputable conferences aligned with the lab's research areas. Below are some conferences of interest, grouped by focus area:

Manufacturing & Automation

- **ASME Manufacturing Science & Engineering Conference (MSEC)** and **NAMRI/SME North American Manufacturing Research Conference (NAMRC)**. Typical submission deadline: November.
- **International Conference on Flexible Automation and Intelligent Manufacturing (FAIM)**. Typical submission deadline: January.
- **IEEE International Conference on Robotics & Automation (ICRA)**. Typical submission deadline: September.
- **IEEE International Conference on Automation Science and Engineering (CASE)**. Typical submission deadline: March.

Design & Computer Graphics

- **ASME International Design Engineering Technical Conferences & Computers and Information in Engineering Conference (IDETC/CIE)**. Typical submission deadline: March.
- **Solid and Physical Modeling (SPM)**. Typical submission deadline: February.
- **Geometric Modeling and Processing (GMP)**. Typical submission deadline: December.
- **ACM SIGGRAPH**. Typical submission deadline: January.
- **World Congresses of Structural and Multidisciplinary Optimization (WCSMO)**. Typical abstract submission deadline: January.
- **3DBODY.TECH Conference**. Typical abstract submission deadline: May.
- **Annual Conference of the Society for Design and Process Science (SDPS)**. Typical submission deadline: August.

General Mechanical

- **Canadian Society for Mechanical Engineering (CSME) Congress**. Typical submission deadline: February.